decided in *Hanson,* and therefore considered whether the Act could fairly be construed to avoid these constitutional issues. 367 U. S., at 749–750.[13] The Court concluded that the Act could be so construed, since only expenditures related to the union's functions in negotiating and administering the collective-bargaining agreement and adjusting grievances and disputes fell within "the reasons . . . accepted by Congress why authority to make union-shop agreements was justified," *id.,* at 768. The Court ruled, therefore, that the use of compulsory union dues for political purposes violated the Act itself. Nonetheless, it found that an injunction against enforcement of the union-shop agreement as such was impermissible under *Hanson,* and remanded the case to the Supreme Court of Georgia so that a more limited remedy could be devised.

The holding in *Hanson,* as elaborated in *Street,* reflects familiar doctrines in the federal labor laws. The principle of exclusive union representation, which underlies the National Labor Relations Act[14] as well as the Railway Labor Act, is a central element in the congressional structuring of industrial relations. *E. g., Emporium Capwell Co.* v. *Western Addition Community Org.,* 420 U. S. 50, 62–63; *NLRB* v. *Allis-Chalmers Mfg. Co.,* 388 U. S. 175, 180; *Medo Corp.* v. *NLRB,* 321 U. S. 678, 684–685; *Virginian R. Co.* v. *System Federation No. 40,* 300 U. S. 515, 545–549. The designation of a single representative avoids the confusion that would result from attempting to enforce two or more agreements specifying different terms and conditions of employment. It prevents inter-union rivalries from creating

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[13] In suggesting that *Street* "significantly undercut," and constituted a "rethinking" of, *Hanson, post,* at 247, the opinion concurring in the judgment loses sight of the fact that the record in *Street,* unlike that in *Hanson,* potentially presented constitutional questions arising from union expenditures for ideological purposes unrelated to collective bargaining.

[14] 29 U. S. C. § 151 *et seq.*